



HSC Mathematics (QLD Specialist)

Matrix Practice

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*"As for everything else, so for a mathematical theory:
beauty can be perceived but not explained."*

Arthur Cayley (Founder of matrix algebra)

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1 Introduction

Remark 1.1 (Syllabus Note)

Matrices are not part of the current NSW NESA Mathematics syllabuses. The content in this booklet is adapted from the Queensland (QCAA) Specialist Mathematics syllabus. It serves as an excellent enrichment topic for students interested in linear algebra, computer graphics, and machine learning.

1.1 Project Overview

This booklet is a growing collection of matrix problems. It introduces matrix arithmetic, determinants, inverses, and applications to solving systems of linear equations and geometric transformations.

1.2 Target Audience

This resource is written for students who want to explore linear algebra beyond the standard NSW syllabus, in a clear, classroom-friendly format.

1.3 How to Use This Booklet

Read the short summary of the core formulas first, then attempt each problem before reading the solution.

1.4 Knowledge Needed

The key background knowledge is:

- Basic arithmetic and algebraic manipulation.
- Understanding of systems of linear equations.
- Basic 2D geometry (for geometric transformations).

1.5 Core Formulas and Ideas

2 Part 1: Worked Problems

2.1 Basic

Problem 2.1: School Demographics Matrix

Based on the demographic data provided in the school census: At a certain school, there are 110 girls and 110 boys in Year 7. The numbers of girls and boys in the other year levels are 120 and 105 in Year 8, 140 and 130 in Year 9, 100 and 95 in Year 10, 90 and 85 in Year 11, and 60 and 65 in Year 12.

- (a) Summarise this information in a 6×2 matrix, S , where the rows represent the year levels (7 to 12) and the columns represent the gender (girls, boys).
- (b) Define a column matrix C such that the matrix product SC results in a 6×1 matrix representing the total number of students in each year level. Calculate SC .
- (c) Define a row matrix R such that the matrix product RS results in a 1×2 matrix representing the total number of girls and boys in the school overall. Calculate RS .
- (d) The school receives an extracurricular grant of \$50 per girl and \$45 per boy. Write down a column matrix G representing these amounts, and calculate the product SG to find the total grant amount allocated to each year level.

Hint:

- **Part (a):** Organise the data sequentially. Ensure your rows correspond to Years 7 through 12, and the first and second columns correspond to girls and boys, respectively.
- **Part (b):** To sum the elements across the rows of a matrix using matrix multiplication, you need to post-multiply by a column matrix of 1s. Check your dimensions: a (6×2) matrix multiplied by a (2×1) matrix yields a (6×1) matrix.
- **Part (c):** To sum the elements down the columns, you must pre-multiply by a row matrix of 1s. Verify the dimensions: (1×6) multiplied by (6×2) .
- **Part (d):** Matrix multiplication pairs the row elements of the first matrix with the column elements of the second matrix. Make sure the \$50 aligns with the girls' column and the \$45 aligns with the boys' column.

Solution 2.1

(a)

$$S = \begin{bmatrix} 110 & 110 \\ 120 & 105 \\ 140 & 130 \\ 100 & 95 \\ 90 & 85 \\ 60 & 65 \end{bmatrix}$$

(b)

$$C = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}, \quad SC = \begin{bmatrix} 110 & 110 \\ 120 & 105 \\ 140 & 130 \\ 100 & 95 \\ 90 & 85 \\ 60 & 65 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 220 \\ 225 \\ 270 \\ 195 \\ 175 \\ 125 \end{bmatrix}$$

(c)

$$R = [1 \quad 1 \quad 1 \quad 1 \quad 1 \quad 1]$$

$$RS = [1 \quad 1 \quad 1 \quad 1 \quad 1 \quad 1] \begin{bmatrix} 110 & 110 \\ 120 & 105 \\ 140 & 130 \\ 100 & 95 \\ 90 & 85 \\ 60 & 65 \end{bmatrix} = [620 \quad 590]$$

(d)

$$G = \begin{bmatrix} 50 \\ 45 \end{bmatrix}, \quad SG = \begin{bmatrix} 110 & 110 \\ 120 & 105 \\ 140 & 130 \\ 100 & 95 \\ 90 & 85 \\ 60 & 65 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 50 \\ 45 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 10450 \\ 10725 \\ 12850 \\ 9275 \\ 8325 \\ 5925 \end{bmatrix}$$

Takeaways 2.1

- **Data Organisation:** Matrices are powerful tools for neatly organising and storing real-world demographic data.
- **Summation Vectors:** Matrix multiplication using vectors of 1s is an efficient algebraic method for summing rows or columns of a data matrix without writing out lengthy addition equations.
- **Dimensionality Checks:** Always verify conformability before multiplying matrices. The number of columns in the leading matrix must equal the number of rows in the trailing matrix (e.g., $m \times n$ multiplied by $n \times p$ gives an $m \times p$ matrix).

2.2 Medium

Problem 2.2: Matrix Properties and Transformations

Consider a general 2×2 matrix $A = \begin{bmatrix} p & q \\ r & s \end{bmatrix}$ and its associated adjugate matrix $A^* = \begin{bmatrix} s & -q \\ -r & p \end{bmatrix}$.

- Evaluate the matrix product AA^* and express the result in the form kI , where I is the 2×2 identity matrix and k is a scalar expressed in terms of p, q, r , and s .
- Given that $k \neq 0$, use your result from part (a) to algebraically deduce the standard expression for the inverse matrix, A^{-1} .
- Evaluate the reverse product A^*A and hence show that for this specific pair of matrices, multiplication is commutative.
- A linear transformation in the plane is represented by the matrix $M = \begin{bmatrix} 2x & 3 \\ 8 & x \end{bmatrix}$.

Using the concept of k from part (a), determine the exact possible values of x for which this transformation cannot be reversed (i.e., the matrix is singular).

Hint:

- **Part (a):** Perform standard row-by-column matrix multiplication. Expand the terms, simplify the diagonals, and factor out any common algebraic expressions to reveal the identity matrix.
- **Part (b):** Recall that the definition of an inverse matrix is $AA^{-1} = I$. Take your equation from part (a), $AA^* = kI$, and manipulate it algebraically to isolate I on one side of the equation.
- **Part (c):** Multiply the matrices again, but this time with A^* on the left and A on the right. Compare the resulting matrix to the one you found in part (a).
- **Part (d):** A matrix transformation does not have an inverse when its associated scalar k (the determinant) is equal to zero. Set up an equation for $k = 0$ using the elements of matrix M and solve for x .

Solution 2.2

(a)

$$AA^* = \begin{bmatrix} p & q \\ r & s \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} s & -q \\ -r & p \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} ps - qr & -pq + qp \\ rs - sr & -rq + sp \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} ps - qr & 0 \\ 0 & ps - qr \end{bmatrix}$$

Factoring out the common term: $AA^* = (ps - qr) \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = (ps - qr)I$.

Therefore, $k = ps - qr$.

(b)

From part (a), we have $AA^* = (ps - qr)I$.

Assuming $ps - qr \neq 0$, we can divide both sides by this scalar:

$$A \left(\frac{1}{ps - qr} A^* \right) = I$$

Since $AA^{-1} = I$, it follows that $A^{-1} = \frac{1}{ps - qr} \begin{bmatrix} s & -q \\ -r & p \end{bmatrix}$.

(c)

$$A^*A = \begin{bmatrix} s & -q \\ -r & p \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} p & q \\ r & s \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} sp - qr & sq - qs \\ -rp + pr & -rq + ps \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} ps - qr & 0 \\ 0 & ps - qr \end{bmatrix} = (ps - qr)I$$

Since $AA^* = (ps - qr)I$ and $A^*A = (ps - qr)I$, we have shown that $AA^* = A^*A$. Thus, multiplication of a matrix by its adjugate is commutative.

(d)

For the transformation to have no inverse, $k = ps - qr = 0$.

For matrix M , $p = 2x$, $q = 3$, $r = 8$, and $s = x$.

$$k = (2x)(x) - (3)(8) = 2x^2 - 24$$

$$\text{Setting } k = 0: 2x^2 - 24 = 0 \implies x^2 = 12 \implies x = \pm\sqrt{12} = \pm 2\sqrt{3}.$$

Takeaways 2.2

- **Determinant:** The scalar value $k = ps - qr$ derived in part (a) is the determinant of a 2×2 matrix. It is the fundamental factor that dictates whether a matrix has an inverse.
- **Commutativity of Inverses:** While general matrix multiplication is strictly non-commutative ($AB \neq BA$), a matrix and its adjugate (or inverse) are a special exception where multiplication order does not change the result.
- **Singular Matrices:** Matrices with a determinant of zero are called singular. Geometrically, these matrices represent transformations that collapse 2D space into a 1D line or a point, which is why the mapping cannot be algebraically reversed.

Problem 2.3: Matrix Algebra and Commutativity

Consider general 2×2 matrices A and B .

- (a) By expanding the product, show that $(A + B)^2 = A^2 + AB + BA + B^2$.
- (b) Hence, state the necessary mathematical condition for matrices A and B such that the standard binomial expansion $(A + B)^2 = A^2 + 2AB + B^2$ is valid.
- (c) Let $A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$ representing a reflection in the x-axis, and $B = \begin{bmatrix} k & 0 \\ 0 & k \end{bmatrix}$ representing a dilation by scale factor k . Verify algebraically that for these specific matrices, $(A + B)^2 = A^2 + 2AB + B^2$.
- (d) Let $C = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$ and $D = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$. Evaluate $(C + D)^2$ and $C^2 + 2CD + D^2$, demonstrating they are not equal, and explain why this algebraic difference occurs in terms of matrix multiplication properties.

Hint:

- **Part (a):** Write $(A + B)^2$ as $(A + B)(A + B)$ and apply the distributive law carefully, ensuring you maintain the exact left-to-right order of matrix multiplication.
- **Part (b):** Compare your expanded result from part (a) to the target expression $A^2 + 2AB + B^2$. What must the middle terms $AB + BA$ simplify to?
- **Part (c):** Calculate the individual products AB and BA first. Check if they satisfy the condition you identified in part (b).
- **Part (d):** For the first expression, perform the matrix addition $C + D$ before squaring the result. For the second expression, calculate C^2 , D^2 , and CD separately before summing them.

Solution 2.3

(a)

$$(A+B)^2 = (A+B)(A+B) = A(A+B) + B(A+B) = A^2 + AB + BA + B^2.$$

(b)

For $A^2 + AB + BA + B^2$ to equal $A^2 + 2AB + B^2$, we must have:

$$AB + BA = 2AB \implies BA = AB.$$

The necessary condition is that matrices A and B must commute.

(c)

$$AB = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} k & 0 \\ 0 & k \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} k & 0 \\ 0 & -k \end{bmatrix}$$

$$BA = \begin{bmatrix} k & 0 \\ 0 & k \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} k & 0 \\ 0 & -k \end{bmatrix}$$

Since $AB = BA$, the matrices commute, and therefore the binomial expansion $(A+B)^2 = A^2 + 2AB + B^2$ holds valid for this specific pair.

(d)

$$C + D = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} + \begin{bmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 2 & 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

$$(C + D)^2 = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 2 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 2 & 0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Next, evaluating the components of the expanded form:

$$C^2 = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = I \text{ and } D^2 = \begin{bmatrix} -1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{bmatrix} = -I.$$

$$CD = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

$$C^2 + 2CD + D^2 = I + 2 \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{bmatrix} - I = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & -2 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Since $\begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \neq \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & -2 \end{bmatrix}$, the expressions are unequal. This occurs because general matrix multiplication is non-commutative ($CD \neq DC$), preventing the cross-terms from simplifying to $2CD$.

Takeaways 2.3

- **Matrix Non-Commutativity:** The most critical difference between standard real number algebra and matrix algebra is that matrix multiplication is generally non-commutative ($AB \neq BA$).
- **Binomial Expansion:** Standard polynomial identities like $(x+y)^2 = x^2 + 2xy + y^2$ cannot be blindly applied to matrices unless the specific matrices are proven to commute.
- **Geometric Connection:** The algebraic failure of commutativity mirrors the geometric reality of transformations. For instance, applying a reflection then a rotation often results in a different final orientation compared to applying the rotation then the reflection.

2.3 Advanced

Problem 2.4: Matrix Inverses and Matrix Equations

Let A and B be 2×2 matrices defined as $A = \begin{bmatrix} k & 2 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ and $B = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 2 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$, where k is a real constant.

- Determine the determinant of A in terms of k , and hence state the value of k for which matrix A is singular.
- Let $k = 3$. Determine the inverse matrices A^{-1} and B^{-1} .
- For $k = 3$, calculate the matrix product AB and hence determine $(AB)^{-1}$.
- Evaluate the product $B^{-1}A^{-1}$ to verify the property $(AB)^{-1} = B^{-1}A^{-1}$. Hence, use this property to make the matrix X the subject of the matrix equation $ABX = C$, where C is a 2×2 matrix.

Hint:

- **Part (a):** The determinant of a 2×2 matrix $\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix}$ is $ad - bc$. A matrix is singular (has no inverse) when its determinant equals zero.

- **Part (b):** Use the formula for the inverse of a 2×2 matrix: $\frac{1}{\det(M)} \begin{bmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{bmatrix}$.

- **Part (c):** Multiply matrix A by matrix B using the standard row-by-column method. Then find the inverse of the resulting 2×2 matrix.

- **Part (d):** Multiply B^{-1} (on the left) by A^{-1} (on the right) and factor out the scalar multipliers. To solve $ABX = C$, remember that you must multiply both sides of the equation by the inverse of AB on the left.

Solution 2.4**(a)**

$$\det(A) = (k)(1) - (2)(-1) = k + 2.$$

For matrix A to be singular, $\det(A) = 0$. Therefore, $k = -2$.

(b)

Given $k = 3$, $A = \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 2 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$.

$$\det(A) = 3 + 2 = 5. \text{ Thus, } A^{-1} = \frac{1}{5} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -2 \\ 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix}.$$

$$\det(B) = (1)(3) - (-1)(2) = 3 + 2 = 5. \text{ Thus, } B^{-1} = \frac{1}{5} \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 1 \\ -2 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

(c)

$$AB = \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 2 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 2 & 3 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 3(1) + 2(2) & 3(-1) + 2(3) \\ -1(1) + 1(2) & -1(-1) + 1(3) \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 7 & 3 \\ 1 & 4 \end{bmatrix}.$$

$$\det(AB) = (7)(4) - (3)(1) = 28 - 3 = 25.$$

$$(AB)^{-1} = \frac{1}{25} \begin{bmatrix} 4 & -3 \\ -1 & 7 \end{bmatrix}.$$

(d)

$$B^{-1}A^{-1} = \left(\frac{1}{5} \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 1 \\ -2 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \right) \left(\frac{1}{5} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -2 \\ 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \right) = \frac{1}{25} \begin{bmatrix} 3(1) + 1(1) & 3(-2) + 1(3) \\ -2(1) + 1(1) & -2(-2) + 1(3) \end{bmatrix} = \frac{1}{25} \begin{bmatrix} 4 & -3 \\ -1 & 7 \end{bmatrix}.$$

This verifies that $(AB)^{-1} = B^{-1}A^{-1}$.

To solve $ABX = C$:

$$(AB)^{-1}(AB)X = (AB)^{-1}C$$

$$IX = (AB)^{-1}C$$

$$X = B^{-1}A^{-1}C.$$

Takeaways 2.4

- **The "Socks and Shoes" Property:** The inverse of a matrix product reverses the order of the original matrices: $(AB)^{-1} = B^{-1}A^{-1}$.
- **Matrix Algebra in Equations:** When isolating a matrix variable (like X in $ABX = C$), you must respect the non-commutative nature of matrices by multiplying by the inverse on the correct side (in this case, pre-multiplying on the left).
- **Determinant of a Product:** Notice that $\det(AB) = 25$, while $\det(A) = 5$ and $\det(B) = 5$. This verifies another key property: $\det(AB) = \det(A) \times \det(B)$.

Problem 2.5: Matrix Inverses and the Zero Matrix

Let A, B, C , and D be 2×2 matrices, where O is the zero matrix and I is the identity matrix.

- (a) Assume A is an invertible matrix and that $AB = O$. Prove algebraically that B must be the zero matrix.
- (b) Suppose instead that C and D are both strictly non-zero matrices, yet their product is the zero matrix ($CD = O$). By referencing your proof in part (a), deduce whether C can be an invertible matrix. Support your answer with logical reasoning.
- (c) A matrix M is defined as being self-inverse if $M^{-1} = M$. By showing this implies $M^2 = I$, determine the algebraic condition on real numbers a, b , and c such that $M = \begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & -a \end{bmatrix}$ is a self-inverse matrix.
- (d) Using your condition from part (c), construct a specific matrix M where $a = 3$, and b and c are integers. Verify that your chosen matrix is self-inverse by explicitly evaluating M^2 .

Hint:

- **Part (a):** Start with the given equation $AB = O$. Since A is invertible, you are permitted to pre-multiply both sides of the equation by A^{-1} . What does $A^{-1}A$ simplify to?
- **Part (b):** Use a proof by contradiction. What would happen if C was invertible? Apply the exact same logic established in part (a) and compare the result to the condition that D is a non-zero matrix.
- **Part (c):** Multiply both sides of $M^{-1} = M$ by M . Then, square the given matrix $M = \begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & -a \end{bmatrix}$ using standard row-by-column multiplication and equate the resulting elements to the corresponding elements of the identity matrix, I .
- **Part (d):** Substitute $a = 3$ into your condition from part (c). Find two integers b and c that multiply together to satisfy the equation, construct the matrix, and manually multiply $M \times M$ to check it yields I .

Solution 2.5**(a)**

Given $AB = O$ and A is invertible, A^{-1} exists. Pre-multiplying both sides by A^{-1} :

$$A^{-1}(AB) = A^{-1}O$$

$$(A^{-1}A)B = O$$

$$IB = O \implies B = O.$$

(b)

Assume for the sake of contradiction that C is invertible.

Then, given $CD = O$, we could pre-multiply by C^{-1} to get $C^{-1}(CD) = C^{-1}O \implies D = O$.

However, the problem states that D is a non-zero matrix. This is a contradiction. Therefore, the assumption that C is invertible must be false; C must be a singular matrix.

(c)

If $M^{-1} = M$, then multiplying both sides by M gives $MM^{-1} = MM \implies I = M^2$.

Evaluating M^2 :

$$M^2 = \begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & -a \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & -a \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} a^2 + bc & ab - ab \\ ac - ac & bc + (-a)^2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} a^2 + bc & 0 \\ 0 & a^2 + bc \end{bmatrix}.$$

For $M^2 = I = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$, we must have the condition: $a^2 + bc = 1$.

(d)

Let $a = 3$. From part (c), $3^2 + bc = 1 \implies 9 + bc = 1 \implies bc = -8$.

Choose integers $b = 2$ and $c = -4$ (other integer pairs like $4, -2$ are also valid).

$$M = \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 2 \\ -4 & -3 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Verification:

$$M^2 = \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 2 \\ -4 & -3 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 2 \\ -4 & -3 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 9 - 8 & 6 - 6 \\ -12 + 12 & -8 + 9 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = I.$$

Takeaways 2.5

- **Zero Product Property Failure:** In real number algebra, $xy = 0$ implies $x = 0$ or $y = 0$. In matrix algebra, $CD = O$ does *not* necessarily mean $C = O$ or $D = O$. Non-zero matrices can multiply to give the zero matrix.
- **Singularity is Key:** For two non-zero matrices to multiply to the zero matrix, they must both be singular (determinant of zero). If either were invertible, the other would be forced to be the zero matrix.
- **Self-Inverse Matrices:** Matrices where $M^{-1} = M$ exist in infinitely many non-trivial forms beyond just the identity matrix. Geometrically, self-inverse (or involutory) matrices often represent reflections, where applying the transformation twice returns all coordinates to their original positions.

Problem 2.6: Matrix Methods for Simultaneous Equations

Consider the following system of simultaneous linear equations with real parameter k :

$$(k - 1)x + 3y = k + 2$$

$$2x + (k - 2)y = 4$$

- (a) Express this system as a matrix equation of the form $AX = B$, and find a simplified quadratic expression for the determinant of the coefficient matrix A .
- (b) Determine the values of k for which the matrix A is singular (i.e., does not have an inverse).
- (c) For each value of k found in part (b), determine whether the system has no solutions or infinitely many solutions. Provide a brief geometric justification for your answers.
- (d) Assuming the matrix A is invertible, use the matrix inverse method to find the unique solution for x and y in terms of k , expressing your final answers in their simplest rational form.

Hint:

- **Part (a):** The coefficient matrix A contains the multipliers for x and y . The determinant of a 2×2 matrix $\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix}$ is calculated as $ad - bc$.

- **Part (b):** A matrix is singular when its determinant is exactly zero. Set your expression from part (a) to zero and solve the resulting quadratic equation for k .

- **Part (c):** Substitute your k values back into the original system of equations. If the two equations represent distinct parallel lines (e.g., yielding a false statement like $0 = 5$), there is no solution. If they represent the exact same line, there are infinitely many solutions.

- **Part (d):** Use the inverse matrix formula $X = A^{-1}B = \frac{1}{\det(A)} \begin{bmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{bmatrix} B$. After multiplying the matrices, factor the resulting numerators to see if they cancel with the determinant in the denominator.

Solution 2.6

(a)

$$\text{Matrix equation: } \begin{bmatrix} k-1 & 3 \\ 2 & k-2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} k+2 \\ 4 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\det(A) = (k-1)(k-2) - (3)(2) = k^2 - 3k + 2 - 6 = k^2 - 3k - 4.$$

$$\text{Factored form: } \det(A) = (k-4)(k+1).$$

(b)

Matrix A is singular when $\det(A) = 0$.

$$k^2 - 3k - 4 = 0 \implies (k-4)(k+1) = 0.$$

Therefore, A is singular when $k = 4$ or $k = -1$.

(c)

Case $k = 4$:Equations become $3x + 3y = 6$ (which simplifies to $x + y = 2$) and $2x + 2y = 4$ (which simplifies to $x + y = 2$).Because the equations represent coincident (identical) lines, there are **infinitely many solutions**.**Case $k = -1$:**Equations become $-2x + 3y = 1$ and $2x - 3y = 4$.Adding the two equations yields $0 = 5$, which is mathematically inconsistent. Because the equations represent distinct parallel lines, there are **no solutions**.

(d)

For $k \neq 4$ and $k \neq -1$, A is invertible.

$$A^{-1} = \frac{1}{(k-4)(k+1)} \begin{bmatrix} k-2 & -3 \\ -2 & k-1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$X = \frac{1}{(k-4)(k+1)} \begin{bmatrix} k-2 & -3 \\ -2 & k-1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} k+2 \\ 4 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$x = \frac{(k-2)(k+2)-12}{(k-4)(k+1)} = \frac{k^2-4-12}{(k-4)(k+1)} = \frac{k^2-16}{(k-4)(k+1)} = \frac{(k-4)(k+4)}{(k-4)(k+1)} = \frac{k+4}{k+1}$$

$$y = \frac{-2(k+2)+4(k-1)}{(k-4)(k+1)} = \frac{-2k-4+4k-4}{(k-4)(k+1)} = \frac{2k-8}{(k-4)(k+1)} = \frac{2(k-4)}{(k-4)(k+1)} = \frac{2}{k+1}$$

$$\text{Unique solution: } x = \frac{k+4}{k+1} \text{ and } y = \frac{2}{k+1}.$$

Takeaways 2.6

- **Determinant as a Geometric Indicator:** Just as the discriminant reveals the nature of roots in a quadratic, the determinant of a coefficient matrix dictates the geometry of linear systems. A non-zero determinant guarantees intersecting lines (one unique solution).
- **Interpreting Singularity:** A singular matrix ($\det = 0$) means the matrix transformation collapses 2D space. For a system of equations, this means the lines share the exact same gradient, resulting in either parallel lines (no intersection) or coincident lines (infinite intersections).
- **Algebraic Simplification:** When solving parametrically with the matrix inverse method, finding the solution often involves polynomial division or factoring. The non-zero roots of the determinant will frequently appear as cancellable factors in the numerators of your x and y expressions.

3 Part 2: Practice and Challenge Bank

3.1 Warm-Up Drills

3.2 Stretch Problems

Problem 3.1: Matrix Systems and Polynomial Curve Fitting

A quadratic function has a rule of the form $f(x) = ax^2 + bx + c$. It is known that the points $(-1, 12)$ and $(1, 4)$ are on the graph of f , alongside a third point $(2, 9)$.

- (a) By substituting the known points, write down three linear equations satisfied by a, b , and c . Formulate this information as a matrix equation of the form $M\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{k}$, where $\mathbf{v} = \begin{bmatrix} a \\ b \\ c \end{bmatrix}$.
- (b) The inverse of the coefficient matrix M is given by $M^{-1} = \frac{1}{6} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -3 & 2 \\ -3 & 3 & 0 \\ 2 & 6 & -2 \end{bmatrix}$. Use this inverse to solve the matrix equation and determine the exact values of a, b , and c .
- (c) Suppose the y -coordinate of the third point is changed to a parameter p , such that the point is now $(2, p)$. Write down the new constant vector $\mathbf{k}$, and use M^{-1} to determine the coefficients a, b , and c in terms of p .
- (d) Determine the specific value of p for which the quadratic function degenerates into a linear function (i.e., $a = 0$). Geometrically, what does this imply about the arrangement of the three points on the Cartesian plane?

Hint:

- **Part (a):** Substitute the x and y values of each coordinate pair into the quadratic equation to generate three distinct linear equations. The coefficients of a, b , and c will form your 3×3 matrix M .
- **Part (b):** To solve $M\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{k}$, pre-multiply both sides by the inverse matrix so that $\mathbf{v} = M^{-1}\mathbf{k}$.
- **Part (c):** Update the third entry of your $\mathbf{k}$ vector to p . Multiply the matrix M^{-1} by this new vector using standard row-by-column multiplication.
- **Part (d):** Take your parametric expression for a from part (c) and set it equal to 0. If a quadratic curve becomes a straight line, consider what that means for the points that define it.

Solution 3.1

(a)

Substituting $(-1, 12)$: $a(-1)^2 + b(-1) + c = 12 \implies a - b + c = 12$ Substituting $(1, 4)$: $a(1)^2 + b(1) + c = 4 \implies a + b + c = 4$ Substituting $(2, 9)$: $a(2)^2 + b(2) + c = 9 \implies 4a + 2b + c = 9$ Matrix equation:
$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 4 & 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} a \\ b \\ c \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 12 \\ 4 \\ 9 \end{bmatrix}.$$

(b)

$$\mathbf{v} = M^{-1}\mathbf{k} = \frac{1}{6} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -3 & 2 \\ -3 & 3 & 0 \\ 2 & 6 & -2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 12 \\ 4 \\ 9 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$a = \frac{1}{6}(1(12) - 3(4) + 2(9)) = \frac{1}{6}(12 - 12 + 18) = 3$$

$$b = \frac{1}{6}(-3(12) + 3(4) + 0(9)) = \frac{1}{6}(-36 + 12) = -4$$

$$c = \frac{1}{6}(2(12) + 6(4) - 2(9)) = \frac{1}{6}(24 + 24 - 18) = 5$$

Therefore, $a = 3$, $b = -4$, and $c = 5$.

(c)

With the new point $(2, p)$, the constant vector becomes $\mathbf{k} = \begin{bmatrix} 12 \\ 4 \\ p \end{bmatrix}$.

$$\mathbf{v} = \frac{1}{6} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -3 & 2 \\ -3 & 3 & 0 \\ 2 & 6 & -2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 12 \\ 4 \\ p \end{bmatrix}$$

$$a = \frac{1}{6}(12 - 12 + 2p) = \frac{2p}{6} = \frac{p}{3}$$

$$b = \frac{1}{6}(-36 + 12 + 0) = -4$$

$$c = \frac{1}{6}(24 + 24 - 2p) = \frac{48-2p}{6} = 8 - \frac{p}{3}.$$

(d)

For the function to be linear, $a = 0$.

$$\frac{p}{3} = 0 \implies p = 0.$$

If $a = 0$, the curve is a straight line $y = -4x + 8$. Geometrically, this implies that the three points $(-1, 12)$, $(1, 4)$, and $(2, 0)$ are perfectly collinear.**Takeaways 3.1**

- **Vandermonde Matrices:** The coefficient matrix formed by fitting a polynomial to coordinate points is known as a Vandermonde matrix. Its determinant is always non-zero as long as the x -coordinates are distinct, guaranteeing a unique polynomial fit.
- **Parametric Matrix Operations:** Treating unknowns as parameters (like p) within a matrix equation allows you to generalize solutions for an entire family of curves at once, rather than re-solving the system from scratch.
- **Geometric Limits:** Setting the leading coefficient of a polynomial to zero algebraically represents flattening the curve's curvature, visually forcing the defining points into a straight line.

3.3 Challenge Corner

Problem 3.2: Parametric Simultaneous Equations and Matrices

Consider the simultaneous linear equations involving real constants m and n :

$$mx + 2y = 4$$

$$8x + my = n$$

- Express this system as a matrix equation of the form $AX = B$. Hence, determine the inverse matrix A^{-1} in terms of m , stating the specific values of m for which A^{-1} is undefined.
- Determine the values of m for which the system does *not* have a unique solution.
- Given that m takes the positive value found in part (b), determine the exact value of n that results in an infinite set of solutions. Furthermore, provide a geometric interpretation of the system if $n = 10$ instead.
- Suppose $n = 2m$. Assuming a unique solution exists, use the matrix inverse method to solve for x and y in terms of m , expressing your final answers in their simplest form.

Hint:

• **Part (a):** Set up the coefficients of x and y into a 2×2 matrix. The formula for the inverse includes dividing by the determinant, $ad - bc$. The inverse is undefined when this determinant is equal to zero.

• **Part (b):** A unique solution exists if and only if the coefficient matrix A is invertible. Therefore, a unique solution does *not* exist when the determinant you found in part (a) is zero.

• **Part (c):** Substitute the positive value of m into the original equations. For infinite solutions, the two line equations must be mathematically equivalent (one is a scalar multiple of the other). If the lines have the same gradient but different y -intercepts, what does that mean geometrically?

• **Part (d):** Substitute $n = 2m$ into your column matrix B . Multiply A^{-1} by B using standard row-by-column multiplication. Simplify the resulting algebraic expressions for x and y by factoring out common terms.

Solution 3.2

(a)

Matrix equation: $\begin{bmatrix} m & 2 \\ 8 & m \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 4 \\ n \end{bmatrix}.$

The determinant is $\det(A) = (m)(m) - (2)(8) = m^2 - 16.$

$$A^{-1} = \frac{1}{m^2-16} \begin{bmatrix} m & -2 \\ -8 & m \end{bmatrix}.$$

The inverse is undefined when $m^2 - 16 = 0$, which occurs when $m = 4$ or $m = -4$.

(b)

The system does not have a unique solution when the coefficient matrix is singular (i.e., $\det(A) = 0$).

From part (a), this occurs when $m = 4$ or $m = -4$.

(c)

Let $m = 4$. The system becomes:

$$(1) \ 4x + 2y = 4 \implies 2x + y = 2$$

$$(2) \ 8x + 4y = n \implies 2x + y = \frac{n}{4}$$

For an infinite set of solutions, the equations must represent the same line. Therefore, $2 = \frac{n}{4} \implies n = 8$.

If $n = 10$, the equations are $2x + y = 2$ and $2x + y = 2.5$. These equations represent distinct, parallel lines that never intersect, meaning there is no solution.

(d)

Let $n = 2m$. The matrix B becomes $\begin{bmatrix} 4 \\ 2m \end{bmatrix}.$

$$X = A^{-1}B = \frac{1}{m^2-16} \begin{bmatrix} m & -2 \\ -8 & m \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 4 \\ 2m \end{bmatrix}$$

$$X = \frac{1}{m^2-16} \begin{bmatrix} (m)(4) + (-2)(2m) \\ (-8)(4) + (m)(2m) \end{bmatrix}$$

$$X = \frac{1}{m^2-16} \begin{bmatrix} 4m - 4m \\ -32 + 2m^2 \end{bmatrix} = \frac{1}{m^2-16} \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 2(m^2 - 16) \end{bmatrix}$$

$$X = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix}.$$

The unique solution simplifies elegantly to $x = 0$ and $y = 2$ (for $m \neq \pm 4$).

Takeaways 3.2

- **Parametric Determinants:** Using parameters in the coefficient matrix directly links algebraic singularity (determinant = 0) to geometric relationships (parallel or coincident lines).
- **Infinite vs. No Solution:** Once a matrix is singular, comparing the constant terms (the B matrix) dictates whether the lines are coincident (infinite solutions) or strictly parallel (no solution).
- **Power of Matrix Algebra:** Part (d) demonstrates how matrix inverse multiplication can elegantly simplify complex parametric systems into clean integer solutions through algebraic factorization.

Problem 3.3: Matrix Systems and Geometric Transformations

Consider the following system of linear equations:

$$\sqrt{3}x - y = 4\sqrt{3}$$

$$x + \sqrt{3}y = 4$$

- Write this system in the matrix form $AX = B$, and determine the exact value of $\det(A)$.
- Determine A^{-1} , and hence solve the system of equations algebraically for $X = \begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \end{bmatrix}$.
- Express the coefficient matrix A in the form $k \begin{bmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{bmatrix}$, where $k > 0$ and $0 \leq \theta \leq \frac{\pi}{2}$. Hence, describe the two sequential geometric transformations represented by the matrix A .
- The matrix equation $AX = B$ can be interpreted geometrically as finding a pre-image point (x, y) that maps to the image point $(4\sqrt{3}, 4)$ under transformation A . Using your geometric description from part (c), deduce the coordinates of (x, y) using polar coordinates and transformations, verifying your algebraic answer from part (b).

Hint:

- Part (a):** Extract the coefficients of x and y carefully. The determinant is calculated as $ad - bc$. Be mindful of squaring surds and negative signs.
- Part (b):** The inverse of a 2×2 matrix is $\frac{1}{\det(A)} \begin{bmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{bmatrix}$. To solve for X , pre-multiply the constant matrix B by A^{-1} .
- Part (c):** Notice that the determinant of a pure rotation matrix is always 1. The determinant of A is not 1, which implies a dilation is present. The dilation factor k is equal to $\sqrt{\det(A)}$. Factor this k out of matrix A to reveal the standard rotation matrix.
- Part (d):** Convert the image point $(4\sqrt{3}, 4)$ into polar form (r, ϕ) . Since applying A dilates and rotates the pre-image *forward*, applying A^{-1} to find the pre-image must do the exact opposite: divide the radius by k and rotate *backwards* by θ .

Solution 3.3

(a)

Matrix form: $\begin{bmatrix} \sqrt{3} & -1 \\ 1 & \sqrt{3} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 4\sqrt{3} \\ 4 \end{bmatrix}$
 $\det(A) = (\sqrt{3})(\sqrt{3}) - (-1)(1) = 3 - (-1) = 4.$

(b)

$A^{-1} = \frac{1}{4} \begin{bmatrix} \sqrt{3} & 1 \\ -1 & \sqrt{3} \end{bmatrix}.$
 $X = A^{-1}B = \frac{1}{4} \begin{bmatrix} \sqrt{3} & 1 \\ -1 & \sqrt{3} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 4\sqrt{3} \\ 4 \end{bmatrix}$
 $X = \frac{1}{4} \begin{bmatrix} \sqrt{3}(4\sqrt{3}) + 1(4) \\ -1(4\sqrt{3}) + \sqrt{3}(4) \end{bmatrix} = \frac{1}{4} \begin{bmatrix} 12 + 4 \\ -4\sqrt{3} + 4\sqrt{3} \end{bmatrix} = \frac{1}{4} \begin{bmatrix} 16 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 4 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}.$
 Therefore, $x = 4$ and $y = 0$.

(c)

Since $\det(A) = 4$, the dilation factor is $k = \sqrt{4} = 2$.

Factoring out 2: $A = 2 \begin{bmatrix} \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} & -\frac{1}{2} \\ \frac{1}{2} & \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} \end{bmatrix}.$

We need $\cos \theta = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}$ and $\sin \theta = \frac{1}{2}$, which gives $\theta = \frac{\pi}{6}$ (or 30°).

Thus, $A = 2 \begin{bmatrix} \cos(\frac{\pi}{6}) & -\sin(\frac{\pi}{6}) \\ \sin(\frac{\pi}{6}) & \cos(\frac{\pi}{6}) \end{bmatrix}.$

Geometrically, matrix A represents a **dilation by a factor of 2** from the origin, followed by an **anti-clockwise rotation of $\frac{\pi}{6}$ radians** about the origin.

(d)

The image point is $(4\sqrt{3}, 4)$. In polar coordinates:

$$r = \sqrt{(4\sqrt{3})^2 + 4^2} = \sqrt{48 + 16} = \sqrt{64} = 8.$$

$$\text{Angle } \phi = \tan^{-1} \left(\frac{4}{4\sqrt{3}} \right) = \tan^{-1} \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} \right) = \frac{\pi}{6}.$$

So the image point is $(8, \frac{\pi}{6})$ in polar.

The inverse transformation A^{-1} reverses the effects of A : it dilates by $\frac{1}{2}$ and rotates clockwise by $\frac{\pi}{6}$.

New radius $r' = 8 \times \frac{1}{2} = 4$.

New angle $\phi' = \frac{\pi}{6} - \frac{\pi}{6} = 0$.

The pre-image in polar coordinates is $(4, 0)$, which corresponds to the Cartesian coordinates $(4, 0)$. This verifies the algebraic solution $x = 4, y = 0$.

Takeaways 3.3

- **Algebra Meets Geometry:** Solving a system of linear equations is algebraically identical to finding the pre-image of a point under a 2D matrix transformation.
- **Identifying Transformations:** Any matrix of the form $\begin{bmatrix} a & -b \\ b & a \end{bmatrix}$ represents a combined rotation and dilation. The dilation factor is $\sqrt{a^2 + b^2}$ (or $\sqrt{\det(A)}$), and the rotation angle θ is found using right-triangle trigonometry with a and b .
- **Inverse Transformations:** If matrix A scales by k and rotates by θ , its inverse A^{-1} scales by $\frac{1}{k}$ and rotates by $-\theta$.

Problem 3.4: Matrix Determinants and System Solutions

Consider the following system of simultaneous linear equations involving the real parameters m and p :

$$\begin{aligned} mx + 2y &= p \\ 12x + (m - 5)y &= 6 \end{aligned}$$

- Express this system in the matrix form $AX = B$. Determine the values of m for which matrix A is not an invertible matrix.
- Let m take the positive value found in part (a). Determine the exact value of p required for the system to have an infinite number of solution pairs. Describe the geometric relationship between the two linear equations in this specific case.
- Let m take the negative value found in part (a). Determine the restriction on p such that the system of equations has no solutions. Describe the geometric relationship between the two linear equations in this case.
- Suppose $p = 4$, and assume that m is chosen such that a unique solution exists. Use the matrix inverse method to solve for the x -coordinate of the solution in terms of m , expressing your final answer as a simplified rational fraction.

Hint:

- **Part (a):** A matrix is not invertible (it is singular) when its determinant equals zero. Extract the coefficients, calculate the determinant using $ad - bc$, set it to zero, and factor the resulting quadratic equation.
- **Part (b):** Substitute your positive m value into the original system. For a linear system to have infinite solutions, the two equations must be scalar multiples of one another (representing coincident lines).
- **Part (c):** Substitute your negative m value into the original system. For a linear system to have no solutions, the lines must have identical gradients but different y -intercepts. What value must p not equal to prevent the lines from overlapping?
- **Part (d):** The inverse matrix is $A^{-1} = \frac{1}{\det(A)} \begin{bmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{bmatrix}$. To find x , you only need to calculate the top row of the matrix multiplication $A^{-1}B$. Look for common factors in the numerator and denominator to simplify.

Solution 3.4**(a)**

Matrix equation: $\begin{bmatrix} m & 2 \\ 12 & m-5 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} p \\ 6 \end{bmatrix}$.

Matrix A is not invertible when $\det(A) = 0$.

$$\det(A) = (m)(m-5) - (2)(12) = m^2 - 5m - 24.$$

$$\text{Setting to zero: } m^2 - 5m - 24 = 0 \implies (m-8)(m+3) = 0.$$

Therefore, A is singular when $m = 8$ or $m = -3$.

(b)

Let $m = 8$. The system becomes:

$$(1) \ 8x + 2y = p \implies 4x + y = \frac{p}{2}$$

$$(2) \ 12x + 3y = 6 \implies 4x + y = 2$$

For infinite solutions, the equations must be equivalent.

$$\text{Therefore, } \frac{p}{2} = 2 \implies p = 4.$$

Geometrically, the equations represent **coincident (identical) straight lines**.

(c)

Let $m = -3$. The system becomes:

$$(1) \ -3x + 2y = p$$

$$(2) \ 12x - 8y = 6 \implies -3x + 2y = -1.5$$

For the system to have no solutions, the equations must be mathematically inconsistent.

Therefore, p can be any real number except -1.5 (i.e., $p \neq -1.5$).

Geometrically, the equations represent **distinct parallel lines** that never intersect.

(d)

Let $p = 4$. For a unique solution, $\det(A) = (m-8)(m+3) \neq 0$.

$$X = A^{-1}B = \frac{1}{(m-8)(m+3)} \begin{bmatrix} m-5 & -2 \\ -12 & m \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 4 \\ 6 \end{bmatrix}.$$

We only need to evaluate the top row for x :

$$x = \frac{4(m-5)+6(-2)}{(m-8)(m+3)} = \frac{4m-20-12}{(m-8)(m+3)} = \frac{4m-32}{(m-8)(m+3)}.$$

Factoring the numerator:

$$x = \frac{4(m-8)}{(m-8)(m+3)}.$$

Since $m \neq 8$, we can cancel the common factor, yielding the simplified solution:

$$x = \frac{4}{m+3}.$$

Takeaways 3.4

- **The Zero Determinant:** When $\det(A) = 0$, a unique solution does not exist. This algebraically signals that the lines are either parallel or coincident.
- **The Role of Constants:** Once singularity is established by the coefficient matrix A , the constant matrix B dictates whether the system collapses into an infinite solution set or an empty set (no solutions).
- **Parametric Simplification:** In matrix algebra, finding a unique parametric solution often leads to rational expressions where the roots of the determinant (e.g., $m-8$) appear as cancellable factors in the numerators.

Problem 3.5: Matrix Systems and Parametric Constants

Consider the following system of linear equations involving a real constant k :

$$kx + 2y = k + 1$$

$$8x + ky = 6$$

- (a) Write this system in the matrix form, as $AX = K$. Determine the values of k for which the coefficient matrix A is not an invertible matrix.
- (b) For the negative value of k found in part (a), determine the geometric relationship between the two linear equations. How many pairs does the solution set contain?
- (c) For the positive value of k found in part (a), demonstrate algebraically whether any solutions can be found for this system of equations. Interpret this result geometrically.
- (d) Let $k = 2$. Calculate A^{-1} and hence find the unique solution pair (x, y) that satisfies the system.

Hint:

- **Part (a):** Matrix A contains the coefficients of x and y . It is not invertible (singular) when its determinant, calculated as $ad - bc$, is equal to zero.
- **Part (b):** Substitute the negative k value back into the original equations. If one equation simplifies to become a direct multiple of the other, they represent the exact same line.
- **Part (c):** Substitute the positive k value. Try to solve the system using elimination; you will reach a false mathematical statement, indicating parallel lines that never cross.
- **Part (d):** Use the inverse matrix formula $A^{-1} = \frac{1}{\det(A)} \begin{bmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{bmatrix}$ and multiply it by the constant column matrix K .

Solution 3.5

(a)

Matrix form: $\begin{bmatrix} k & 2 \\ 8 & k \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} k+1 \\ 6 \end{bmatrix}.$

The matrix A is not invertible when $\det(A) = 0$.

$$\det(A) = (k)(k) - (2)(8) = k^2 - 16.$$

$$\text{Setting to zero: } k^2 - 16 = 0 \implies k = 4 \text{ or } k = -4.$$

(b)

Let $k = -4$. The system becomes:

$$(1) -4x + 2y = -3$$

$$(2) 8x - 4y = 6 \implies -4x + 2y = -3$$

The equations are mathematically identical. Geometrically, they represent **coincident lines**. Because they overlap entirely, the solution set contains an **infinite number of pairs**.

(c)

Let $k = 4$. The system becomes:

$$(1) 4x + 2y = 5$$

$$(2) 8x + 4y = 6 \implies 4x + 2y = 3$$

Subtracting the simplified second equation from the first gives $0 = 2$, which is a contradiction. Therefore, **no solutions can be found**. Geometrically, they represent **distinct parallel lines** that never intersect.

(d)

For $k = 2$, $A = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 2 \\ 8 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$ and $K = \begin{bmatrix} 3 \\ 6 \end{bmatrix}.$

$$\det(A) = (2)(2) - (2)(8) = 4 - 16 = -12.$$

$$A^{-1} = -\frac{1}{12} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & -2 \\ -8 & 2 \end{bmatrix}.$$

$$X = A^{-1}K = -\frac{1}{12} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & -2 \\ -8 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 3 \\ 6 \end{bmatrix} = -\frac{1}{12} \begin{bmatrix} 6 - 12 \\ -24 + 12 \end{bmatrix} = -\frac{1}{12} \begin{bmatrix} -6 \\ -12 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{2} \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

The unique solution pair is $(\frac{1}{2}, 1)$.

Takeaways 3.5

- **Singularity and Geometry:** A non-invertible (singular) coefficient matrix indicates that the system does not have a unique solution; the lines are either parallel or coincident.
- **The Role of Constant Matrices:** The constant terms determine the final state of a singular system. Equivalent ratios across all terms yield infinite solutions (coincident), while differing constant ratios yield zero solutions (parallel).
- **Direct Solutions:** The matrix inverse method provides a direct, algorithmic approach to solving uniquely determined systems without requiring manual substitution or elimination.

Problem 3.6: Matrix Algebra and Transformations

Consider the 3×3 matrix $A = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & \sqrt{3} \\ 0 & \sqrt{3} & -1 \end{bmatrix}$.

- Determine A^2 and express your result in the form kI , where I is the 3×3 identity matrix and k is a real constant.
- Hence, algebraically deduce the inverse matrix A^{-1} without calculating the determinant.
- A 3D linear transformation represented by matrix A maps a coordinate point $P(x, y, z)$ to the image point $P'(4, -2, 2\sqrt{3})$. Use your result from part (b) to determine the exact coordinates of the original point P .
- Using the properties established in part (a), evaluate A^3 and hence determine an expression for A^5 strictly in terms of A .

Hint:

- **Part (a):** Perform standard 3×3 matrix multiplication ($A \times A$). Be careful when multiplying the surds in the second and third rows.
- **Part (b):** The definition of an inverse matrix is $AA^{-1} = I$. Take your equation from part (a), $A^2 = kI$, and algebraically manipulate it to isolate I on one side of the equation.
- **Part (c):** The transformation is defined by the equation $AP = P'$. To solve for the pre-image P , you must pre-multiply both sides of the equation by A^{-1} .
- **Part (d):** Do not calculate the matrices manually. Use exponent rules for matrices: $A^3 = A^2 \times A$. Substitute the identity relationship you found in part (a) to simplify the powers.

Solution 3.6**(a)**

$$A^2 = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & \sqrt{3} \\ 0 & \sqrt{3} & -1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & \sqrt{3} \\ 0 & \sqrt{3} & -1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$A^2 = \begin{bmatrix} (2)(2) + 0 + 0 & 0 + 0 + 0 & 0 + 0 + 0 \\ 0 + 0 + 0 & (1)(1) + (\sqrt{3})(\sqrt{3}) + 0 & (1)(\sqrt{3}) + (\sqrt{3})(-1) + 0 \\ 0 + 0 + 0 & (\sqrt{3})(1) + (-1)(\sqrt{3}) + 0 & (\sqrt{3})(\sqrt{3}) + (-1)(-1) + 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$A^2 = \begin{bmatrix} 4 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 + 3 & \sqrt{3} - \sqrt{3} \\ 0 & \sqrt{3} - \sqrt{3} & 3 + 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 4 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 4 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 4 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$A^2 = 4 \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = 4I.$$

Therefore, $k = 4$.**(b)**From part (a), $A^2 = 4I$.

$$A \cdot A = 4I$$

Dividing both sides by the scalar 4:

$$A \cdot \left(\frac{1}{4}A\right) = I$$

Since $A \cdot A^{-1} = I$, it follows that $A^{-1} = \frac{1}{4}A$.

$$A^{-1} = \begin{bmatrix} 1/2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1/4 & \sqrt{3}/4 \\ 0 & \sqrt{3}/4 & -1/4 \end{bmatrix}.$$

(c)Given $AP = P'$, we have $P = A^{-1}P'$.Using $A^{-1} = \frac{1}{4}A$:

$$P = \frac{1}{4} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & \sqrt{3} \\ 0 & \sqrt{3} & -1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 4 \\ -2 \\ 2\sqrt{3} \end{bmatrix}$$

$$P = \frac{1}{4} \begin{bmatrix} (2)(4) + 0 + 0 \\ 0 + (1)(-2) + (\sqrt{3})(2\sqrt{3}) \\ 0 + (\sqrt{3})(-2) + (-1)(2\sqrt{3}) \end{bmatrix}$$

$$P = \frac{1}{4} \begin{bmatrix} 8 \\ -2 + 6 \\ -2\sqrt{3} - 2\sqrt{3} \end{bmatrix} = \frac{1}{4} \begin{bmatrix} 8 \\ 4 \\ -4\sqrt{3} \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \\ -\sqrt{3} \end{bmatrix}.$$

The coordinates of P are $(2, 1, -\sqrt{3})$.**(d)**

$$A^3 = A^2 \cdot A = (4I)A = 4A.$$

$$A^5 = A^3 \cdot A^2 = (4A)(4I) = 16A.$$

$$\text{Alternatively, } A^5 = A(A^2)^2 = A(4I)^2 = 16A.$$

Takeaways 3.6

- **The “Hence” Command:** In mathematics, the word “hence” dictates that you must use the result of the previous section. Finding the inverse via $A^2 = kI$ is often faster and less prone to arithmetic error than manually calculating a 3×3 determinant and adjugate matrix.
- **Matrix Power Cycles:** Matrices that satisfy equations like $A^2 = kI$ act similarly to cyclic numbers in modular arithmetic. High powers of the matrix can be drastically simplified without performing tedious sequential multiplication.
- **Geometric Inverses:** Algebraically isolating a coordinate vector by multiplying by an inverse matrix geometrically represents reversing the original 3D transformation to find the starting position.

Problem 3.7: Systems of Linear Equations and 3D Geometry

Consider the following system of simultaneous linear equations representing three planes in 3D space, where k is a real constant:

$$x + 2y - 3z = 4$$

$$x + y + z = 6$$

$$2x + 3y + kz = 10$$

- Express this system in the matrix form $AX = B$. Calculate the determinant of the 3×3 coefficient matrix A in terms of k , and hence determine the value of k for which the matrix is singular.
- For the value of k found in part (a), demonstrate algebraically that the system is consistent (has solutions) rather than inconsistent (no solutions).
- Given that the system is consistent and has infinitely many solutions, let $z = \lambda$. Solve the equations to express x and y in terms of the parameter λ .
- Express the general solution from part (c) as a vector equation of a line in the form $\mathbf{r} = \mathbf{a} + \lambda \mathbf{d}$, and briefly describe the geometric arrangement of the three planes.

Hint:

- **Part (a):** The determinant of a 3×3 matrix can be found by expanding across the top row. A matrix is singular when its determinant is equal to zero.
- **Part (b):** Look for a linear combination of the first two equations that perfectly yields the third equation. If the left-hand side and right-hand side both match, the system is consistent.
- **Part (c):** Subtract the second equation from the first to eliminate x and find y in terms of z . Then substitute this back into the second equation to find x . Finally, replace z with λ .
- **Part (d):** Separate the constant terms from the terms containing λ to form your position vector $\mathbf{a}$ and direction vector $\mathbf{d}$.

Solution 3.7**(a)**

Matrix form: $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & -3 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 2 & 3 & k \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \\ z \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 4 \\ 6 \\ 10 \end{bmatrix}.$

$$\det(A) = 1(1(k) - 1(3)) - 2(1(k) - 1(2)) + (-3)(1(3) - 1(2))$$

$$\det(A) = (k - 3) - 2(k - 2) - 3(1)$$

$$\det(A) = k - 3 - 2k + 4 - 3 = -k - 2.$$

$$\text{For } A \text{ to be singular, } \det(A) = 0 \implies -k - 2 = 0 \implies k = -2.$$

(b)

Substitute $k = -2$ into the third equation: $2x + 3y - 2z = 10$.

Let Equation 1 be $x + 2y - 3z = 4$ and Equation 2 be $x + y + z = 6$.

Adding Equation 1 and Equation 2 gives:

$$(x + x) + (2y + y) + (-3z + z) = 4 + 6$$

$$2x + 3y - 2z = 10.$$

Since this perfectly matches the third equation, the third plane contains the line of intersection of the first two planes. The system is consistent.

(c)

Let $z = \lambda$.

Subtracting Eq 2 from Eq 1:

$$(x + 2y - 3z) - (x + y + z) = 4 - 6$$

$$y - 4z = -2 \implies y = 4z - 2 \implies y = 4\lambda - 2.$$

Substitute $y = 4\lambda - 2$ into Eq 2:

$$x + (4\lambda - 2) + \lambda = 6$$

$$x + 5\lambda - 2 = 6 \implies x = 8 - 5\lambda.$$

(d)

From part (c), we have $x = 8 - 5\lambda$, $y = -2 + 4\lambda$, $z = 0 + 1\lambda$.

In vector form:

$$\begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \\ z \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 8 \\ -2 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} + \lambda \begin{bmatrix} -5 \\ 4 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Geometrically, the three planes intersect along a single common line (forming a sheaf of planes).

Takeaways 3.7

- **Underdetermined vs. Singular Systems:** The original 2×3 system implicitly represented infinite solutions because there were more variables than equations. By adding a dependent third equation, we transition to a 3×3 singular matrix scenario, a core concept in QCAA Specialist Mathematics.
- **Singularity and Consistency:** A determinant of zero only tells you a unique solution does not exist. You must verify algebraically whether the planes are parallel/form a prism (inconsistent) or intersect along a line (consistent).
- **Parametric Lines:** The process of setting a free variable to λ is exactly how the Cartesian equations of intersecting planes are converted into the vector equation of a 3D line.

Problem 3.8: Augmented Matrices and Parametric Solutions

Consider the following system of linear equations involving four variables (x, y, z, w) and a real constant k :

$$\begin{aligned}x + 2y - z + w &= 5 \\2x - y + 3z - 2w &= 0 \\3x + y + 2z - w &= k\end{aligned}$$

- Set up the augmented matrix for this system. By applying elementary row operations (specifically, examining $R_1 + R_2$), determine the exact value of k for which this system is consistent (has solutions).
- Given that the system is consistent, it will have a doubly-infinite family of solutions. Let $z = \lambda$ and $w = \mu$. Express x and y strictly in terms of the parameters λ and μ .
- A new constraint is added to the system such that $x - y = 3$. Determine the linear relationship that must exist between the parameters λ and μ to satisfy this constraint.
- Using your result from part (c), determine the unique solution for the coordinates (x, y, z, w) when $w = 2$.

- Hint:**
- **Part (a):** Write the system as an augmented matrix $[A|B]$. Notice that adding the first two rows together creates a row that has the exact same variable coefficients as the third row. For the system to be consistent, the constant terms must also match.
 - **Part (b):** Since the third equation is redundant when consistent, use only the first two equations. Substitute $z = \lambda$ and $w = \mu$, moving them to the right-hand side. Then use simultaneous elimination on x and y .
 - **Part (c):** Substitute your parametric expressions for x and y from part (b) into the equation $x - y = 3$ and group the like parameter terms together.
 - **Part (d):** Substitute $w = \mu = 2$ into your relationship from part (c) to find the value of λ (which represents z). Then, plug both parameter values back into your expressions for x and y .

Solution 3.8

(a)

The augmented matrix is:

$$\left[\begin{array}{cccc|c} 1 & 2 & -1 & 1 & 5 \\ 2 & -1 & 3 & -2 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 & 2 & -1 & k \end{array} \right]$$

Performing the row operation $R_1 + R_2 \rightarrow R_{new}$:

$$(1+2)x + (2-1)y + (-1+3)z + (1-2)w = 5+0 \implies 3x + y + 2z - w = 5.$$

Comparing this to Row 3 ($3x + y + 2z - w = k$), we can see that for the system to be mathematically consistent, $k = 5$.

(b)

Let $z = \lambda$ and $w = \mu$. The system reduces to the first two equations:

$$(1) \quad x + 2y = 5 + \lambda - \mu$$

$$(2) \quad 2x - y = -3\lambda + 2\mu$$

Multiply (2) by 2: $4x - 2y = -6\lambda + 4\mu$.

$$\text{Add to (1): } 5x = 5 - 5\lambda + 3\mu \implies x = 1 - \lambda + \frac{3}{5}\mu.$$

$$\text{Multiply (1) by 2: } 2x + 4y = 10 + 2\lambda - 2\mu.$$

$$\text{Subtract (2) from this: } 5y = 10 + 5\lambda - 4\mu \implies y = 2 + \lambda - \frac{4}{5}\mu.$$

(c)

Apply the constraint: $x - y = 3$.

$$(1 - \lambda + \frac{3}{5}\mu) - (2 + \lambda - \frac{4}{5}\mu) = 3$$

$$-1 - 2\lambda + \frac{7}{5}\mu = 3$$

$$-2\lambda + \frac{7}{5}\mu = 4.$$

Multiplying by 5 yields the linear relationship: $-10\lambda + 7\mu = 20$.

(d)

Given $w = 2$, we have $\mu = 2$.

Substitute into the relationship from (c):

$$-10\lambda + 7(2) = 20 \implies -10\lambda + 14 = 20 \implies -10\lambda = 6 \implies \lambda = -\frac{3}{5}.$$

So, $z = -0.6$.

$$\text{Find } x: x = 1 - (-\frac{3}{5}) + \frac{3}{5}(2) = 1 + \frac{3}{5} + \frac{6}{5} = \frac{14}{5} = 2.8.$$

$$\text{Find } y: y = 2 + (-\frac{3}{5}) - \frac{4}{5}(2) = 2 - \frac{3}{5} - \frac{8}{5} = -\frac{1}{5} = -0.2.$$

The unique solution is $(x, y, z, w) = (\frac{14}{5}, -\frac{1}{5}, -\frac{3}{5}, 2)$ or $(2.8, -0.2, -0.6, 2)$.

Takeaways 3.8

- **Underdetermined Systems:** Matrices representing systems with fewer independent equations than variables yield infinite families of solutions requiring parameters (λ, μ) .
- **Row Operations for Consistency:** Elementary row operations on augmented matrices quickly reveal inconsistencies (e.g., $0 = c$ where $c \neq 0$). If a row reduces entirely to zero on the left, the right side must also be zero for a solution to exist.
- **Applying Constraints:** Adding constraints to a parametric solution family reduces its degrees of freedom. Each new valid equation removes one parameter, eventually leading to a single unique point if enough constraints are provided.

Problem 3.9: Advanced Matrix Products and Inverses

Let $C = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & -1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 2 \\ -1 & 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$ and $D = \begin{bmatrix} -2 & 0 & -2 \\ -1 & -1 & -3 \\ 1 & -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$.

- (a) Evaluate the matrix product CD . Hence, determine the inverse matrices C^{-1} and D^{-1} in terms of C and D .
- (b) A system of simultaneous linear equations is given by:

$$\begin{aligned} -2x - 2z &= 4k \\ -x - y - 3z &= 2 \\ x - y + z &= -2k \end{aligned}$$

Express this system in the form $DX = V$, and hence solve for x, y , and z in terms of the real constant k .

- (c) Determine the specific value of k such that the solution point (x, y, z) lies on the plane defined by $x + z = 4$.
- (d) Using the inverse properties established in part (a), solve the matrix equation $CYD = I$ for the 3×3 matrix Y , where I is the identity matrix.

Hint:

- **Part (a):** Multiply rows of C by columns of D . The result will be a scalar multiple of the identity matrix, mI . Use the definition of an inverse ($MM^{-1} = I$) to isolate I .
- **Part (b):** The coefficient matrix of the system matches matrix D . To solve $DX = V$, pre-multiply both sides by D^{-1} . Substitute your expression for D^{-1} from part (a) to avoid recalculating an inverse from scratch.
- **Part (c):** Substitute the expressions for x and z (which you found in terms of k in part b) into the plane equation and solve for k .
- **Part (d):** Do not attempt to define Y with 9 unknown variables. Instead, isolate Y algebraically by pre-multiplying by C^{-1} and post-multiplying by D^{-1} . Remember that a matrix commutes with its own inverse (e.g., $CD = mI \Rightarrow DC = mI$).

Solution 3.9

(a)

$$CD = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & -1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 2 \\ -1 & 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} -2 & 0 & -2 \\ -1 & -1 & -3 \\ 1 & -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} -4+1+1 & 0+1-1 & -4+3+1 \\ -2+0+2 & 0+0-2 & -2+0+2 \\ 2-1-1 & 1-1+1 & 2-3-1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$CD = \begin{bmatrix} -2 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -2 \end{bmatrix} = -2I.$$

Since $CD = -2I$, we have $C(-\frac{1}{2}D) = I$, so $C^{-1} = -\frac{1}{2}D$.

Similarly, $(-\frac{1}{2}C)D = I$, so $D^{-1} = -\frac{1}{2}C$.

(b)

The system is $D \begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \\ z \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 4k \\ 2 \\ -2k \end{bmatrix}$.

$$X = D^{-1}V = -\frac{1}{2}CV = -\frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & -1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 2 \\ -1 & 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 4k \\ 2 \\ -2k \end{bmatrix}$$

$$X = -\frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 2(4k) - 1(2) + 1(-2k) \\ 1(4k) + 0(2) + 2(-2k) \\ -1(4k) + 1(2) - 1(-2k) \end{bmatrix} = -\frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 6k - 2 \\ 0 \\ -2k + 2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 - 3k \\ 0 \\ k - 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Thus, $x = 1 - 3k$, $y = 0$, and $z = k - 1$.

(c)

We require $x + z = 4$.

Substituting the results from (b):

$$(1 - 3k) + (k - 1) = 4$$

$$-2k = 4 \Rightarrow k = -2.$$

(d)

Given $CYD = I$.

Pre-multiply by C^{-1} and post-multiply by D^{-1} :

$$Y = C^{-1}ID^{-1} = C^{-1}D^{-1}.$$

Substitute the inverses from part (a):

$$Y = (-\frac{1}{2}D)(-\frac{1}{2}C) = \frac{1}{4}DC.$$

Since $CD = -2I$, it follows that $DC = -2I$ (a matrix and its inverse commute).

$$Y = \frac{1}{4}(-2I) = -\frac{1}{2}I = \begin{bmatrix} -0.5 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -0.5 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -0.5 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Takeaways 3.9

- **The “Hence” Method:** Calculating 3×3 inverses from scratch using determinants and adjugates is tedious. Finding a product $AB = mI$ is a standard shortcut to define $A^{-1} = \frac{1}{m}B$.
- **Parametric Systems:** Matrices handle parametric constants (like k) effortlessly because matrix multiplication distributes linearly over expressions.
- **Matrix Algebra vs. Arithmetic:** Part (d) demonstrates the power of abstract matrix algebra. Treating matrices as single algebraic entities (C^{-1} , D^{-1}) avoids massive blocks of arithmetic calculation.

Problem 3.10: Matrix Systems and Planes in 3D Space

Consider the points $A(1, 2, -1)$, $B(2, 3, 1)$, and $C_k(3, -1, k)$, where k is a real constant. A plane containing these three points can be modeled by the equation $ax + by + cz = 1$, provided the plane does not pass through the origin.

- Substitute the coordinates of the three points into the plane equation to formulate a system of three linear equations in terms of a , b , and c . Express this system as a matrix equation $M\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{u}$, and find $\det(M)$ in terms of k .
- Determine the value of k for which the matrix M is singular. Explain why the matrix equation $M\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{u}$ has no solution for this value of k , and what this implies about the geometric position of the plane containing A , B , and C_k relative to the origin.
- Let $k = 2$, corresponding to the specific point $C_2(3, -1, 2)$. Solve the system using Gaussian elimination (row reduction) to find the values of a , b , and c , and hence state the unique equation of the plane in the form $ax + by + cz + d = 0$ with integer coefficients.
- For the singular case where $k = 18$, the plane must pass through the origin. Set up a new homogeneous matrix equation for the plane $a'x + b'y + c'z = 0$, and find the specific Cartesian equation of this plane by letting $a' = 5$.

Hint:

- **Part (a):** Replace $x, y,$ and z with the coordinates of each point to create three distinct equations. Extract the coefficients of $a, b,$ and c to form the 3×3 matrix M . Calculate the determinant by expanding across the top row.
- **Part (b):** A matrix is singular when its determinant equals zero. If setting $ax + by + cz = 1$ yields a singular matrix and an inconsistent system, it means no such plane exists that misses the origin.
- **Part (c):** Form the augmented matrix $[M|\mathbf{u}]$ and use elementary row operations to reach upper triangular form. Back-substitute to find $c, b,$ and a . Multiply the entire plane equation by the lowest common denominator to remove fractions.
- **Part (d):** A plane through the origin equates to 0 rather than 1. Substitute the points $A, B,$ and C_{18} to form a homogeneous system $M\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{0}$. Use the first two equations to express b' and c' strictly in terms of a' , then substitute $a' = 5$.

Solution 3.10**(a)**Substituting the points into $ax + by + cz = 1$:

$$A(1, 2, -1) \implies a + 2b - c = 1$$

$$B(2, 3, 1) \implies 2a + 3b + c = 1$$

$$C_k(3, -1, k) \implies 3a - b + kc = 1$$

$$\text{Matrix equation: } \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & -1 \\ 2 & 3 & 1 \\ 3 & -1 & k \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} a \\ b \\ c \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

$$\det(M) = 1(3k - (-1)) - 2(2k - 3) + (-1)(-2 - 9) = 3k + 1 - 4k + 6 + 11 = 18 - k.$$

(b)Matrix M is singular when $\det(M) = 0 \implies 18 - k = 0 \implies k = 18$.

When $k = 18$, the system is inconsistent (parallel planes in the row space), meaning no unique solution exists for $ax + by + cz = 1$. Geometrically, this implies the plane containing A, B , and C_{18} must pass exactly through the origin, meaning its true equation is of the form $ax + by + cz = 0$, not 1.

(c)Let $k = 2$. The augmented matrix is:

$$\left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 2 & -1 & 1 \\ 2 & 3 & 1 & 1 \\ 3 & -1 & 2 & 1 \end{array} \right]$$

$$R_2 \rightarrow R_2 - 2R_1 \implies \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 2 & -1 & 1 \\ 0 & -1 & 3 & -1 \\ 3 & -1 & 2 & 1 \end{array} \right]$$

$$R_3 \rightarrow R_3 - 3R_1 \implies \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 2 & -1 & 1 \\ 0 & -1 & 3 & -1 \\ 0 & -7 & 5 & -2 \end{array} \right]$$

$$R_3 \rightarrow R_3 - 7R_2 \implies \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 2 & -1 & 1 \\ 0 & -1 & 3 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & -16 & 5 \end{array} \right]$$

$$\text{From } R_3: -16c = 5 \implies c = -\frac{5}{16}.$$

$$\text{From } R_2: -b + 3(-\frac{5}{16}) = -1 \implies b = \frac{1}{16}.$$

$$\text{From } R_1: a + 2(\frac{1}{16}) - (-\frac{5}{16}) = 1 \implies a = \frac{9}{16}.$$

The equation is $\frac{9}{16}x + \frac{1}{16}y - \frac{5}{16}z = 1$, which simplifies to $9x + y - 5z - 16 = 0$.

(d)For $k = 18$, the homogeneous system is:

$$(1) a' + 2b' - c' = 0$$

$$(2) 2a' + 3b' + c' = 0$$

$$(3) 3a' - b' + 18c' = 0$$

$$\text{Add (1) and (2) to eliminate } c': 3a' + 5b' = 0 \implies b' = -\frac{3}{5}a'.$$

$$\text{Let } a' = 5 \implies b' = -3.$$

$$\text{Substitute into (1): } 5 + 2(-3) - c' = 0 \implies -1 - c' = 0 \implies c' = -1.$$

The equation of the plane is $5x - 3y - z = 0$.

Takeaways 3.10

- **Non-Homogeneous vs Homogeneous Form:** Setting a plane's constant d to a non-zero value allows for a quick 3×3 matrix setup, but it operates on the assumption that the plane does not cross the origin.
- **Geometric Meaning of Singularity:** If the resulting matrix determinant is zero, it algebraically signals that the initial assumption (the plane avoids the origin) is false for that specific set of points.
- **Gaussian Elimination:** Row reduction is a powerful tool for solving 3×3 systems without needing to calculate cumbersome matrix inverses or adjugates manually.

4 Conclusion

Matrices provide a powerful language for describing and solving complex systems. As this booklet grows, it will become a compact reference for matrix operations and transformations.

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A Appendices

A.1 Further Reading in Linear Algebra